understanding the long-term development of political organization and political culture in Myanmar's young democracy.

Notes

1 I adopt a broad conception of civil society in this article, including in it any non-profit organization or network not funded by or directly managed by the state. The term does not imply any sense of discursive autonomy or that the activities of civil society groups have a democratic component. Nor does it suggest total autonomy from interference or regulation by the state.
2 Interviews with traders and businessman in Taungoo, 2015 and 2016.
3 Other scholars noting the growth in community-based welfare groups include Helen James (2005), Ashley South (2004), Petrie and South (2014) and Jasmin Lorch (2006, 2007, 2008).
4 Navigating the constraints of regime suppression led organizations to frame their activities and objectives in non-political terms (Heidel 2006, pp. 38–39), a strategy which enabled community groups to both engage and elicit participation from both citizens and state apparatuses.
5 Interviews with volunteers at Taungoo medical centres, April 2015. See Walton (2012, pp. 178–83) for a discussion of *parahita* and Buddhist notions of giving.
6 Interview with local representative of Byama-so in Taungoo, 30 April 2015.
7 Exchange rates are calculated at the average Myanmar Kyat to USD rate for the months of July to October 2015, based on oanda.com historical exchange rates.
8 The commitments of monasteries to MaBaTha are known both by word of mouth as well as by signs hanging at the entrances to their compounds indicating endorsement of the group.
9 With the increasing accessibility of SIM cards (US$1.50) and web-enabled smartphones (US$35), social debate is now increasingly taking digital forms such as SMS and Facebook exchanges for the estimated twenty per cent of the population with access to mobile phones (as of mid-2015).
10 The notion that the NLD is soft on national religion was a feature of the MaBaTha national conference held in Yangon in July 2015, and also recurred in pamphlets distributed both at monasteries and online in Taungoo. In order to skirt electoral regulations about the use of religion issued by the Union Election Commission, the latter did not refer to the NLD explicitly. Instead they referenced "a party focused only on rule of law, education, human rights and livelihoods", an unmistakable reference to the NLD for all of my informants. See Aung Kyaw Min (2015).
11 In fact his village was one of a few in the entire township where USDP won a